

Classroom SEL pack, a week on kindness, ages 3 to 7

Secret Hero

A five-day plan with everything to print: word cards, a poster, a feelings chart, sequencing cards, activity cards, promise cards, an observation grid, exit tickets and family letters in five languages. The Home Activity Pack is included at the back.

Classroom licence: one teacher may print and copy this pack for their own class and students' families. Please don't share the file or post it online.

The week at a glance

About 20 to 30 minutes a day. Each day stands alone if you only have time for one.

Day	What you do	Print
Day 1 Read and learn the words	Read the story with the pause points. Teach the five words with gestures. Put up the poster and word cards.	Pages 3, 4, 5
Day 2 Feelings	Feelings check-in. Re-read the book and talk about how the characters felt, using the talk questions.	Pages 6, 9
Day 3 Retell	Mix up the sequencing cards and put the story back in order as a class. Retell with “First… Then… At the end…”.	Page 7
Day 4 Secret heroes week	Each child does one quiet kind thing each day (with a grown-up nearby): tidying a shelf, putting a classmate’s coat on its hook. When someone notices a kindness, they dro…	Page 8
Day 5 Who did this?	Who did this?, then promise cards and exit tickets. Send the family letter home.	Pages 8, 10, 14 to 16

Ontario Kindergarten frames

Belonging and Contributing, Self-Regulation and Well-Being, Problem Solving and Innovating, Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours

Materials

The book (or the class screen), small paper hearts, a ‘secret hero’ box, a toy egg and nest (optional)

Also in this pack

All 12 pages of the Home Activity Pack (from page 17), which you may copy for your class. Book languages: English.

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Day 1: the read-aloud

Before (3 minutes)

Show the cover. Ask: Who do you think the secret hero is? What could a little bunny do to help? Ask: How does it feel when someone helps you? How does it feel when you help someone? Take a few answers. Teach the animals' question with a puzzled face and open hands: 'Who did this?' Ask children to say it with you each time.

During: stop, ask, listen (10 minutes)

Spread	What happens	Ask	Listen for
3	The watering hole dries up.	Why are the animals worried?	no water to drink
4	Tap-tap! Clink-clank! Bunny fixes the pipe.	How do you think the animals felt when they woke up and found water?	happy, surprised, curious
6	Bunny carries the egg back to the nest.	Why do you think Bunny helps at night?	so no one sees him, he is shy
7	Bunny hops away unseen.	How do you think Mama Bird feels?	happy, thankful, relieved
9	Scrape-scrape! Swish-swish! Bunny clears the snow.	What problem is Bunny fixing now?	the paths are covered, the animals can't find food
11	'It's about making someone's day better.'	Why do you think Bunny liked to help in secret?	he doesn't need praise, it's about others feeling better
12	The monkey clears water paths.	Why did the monkey start helping too?	he was inspired by the secret hero
13	The forest fills with hidden kindness.	How did the forest change?	everyone helps, it's a better place

Spread numbers match the reader on the class screen. You don't need every stop.

Handle with care: Saying thank you and being seen are good things too. Bunny's quietness is his choice, not a rule for everyone. More notes on the "For every child" page.

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Word wall cards

Cut out and add to your word wall. Teach each word with its gesture.

secret

something only you know

Do it: put a finger to your lips

shy

a bit nervous around others

Do it: peek through your fingers

fix

to make something work again

Do it: pretend to tap with a little hammer

hero

someone who helps others

Do it: stand tall with hands on hips

kindness

being gentle and helpful to others

Do it: make a heart with your hands

Who did this?

Say it together whenever it comes up in the story.

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It’s not about being noticed. It’s about making someone’s day better.

Who did this?

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How do you feel today?

Post at circle time. Children clip a peg with their name on a face.
Characters' feelings change during a story, and ours can too.



happy

clip your name here



sad

clip your name here



worried

clip your name here



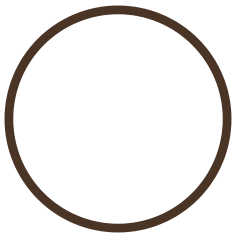
angry

clip your name here



proud

clip your name here



something else

clip your name here

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Sequencing cards

Cut apart for the pocket chart. The four scenes come from the start, two middles and the end of the book, mixed up. Put them in order and retell. Children can color them too.









Answer key, top left to bottom right: 3, 1, 4, 2.

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Activity cards

Cut out and keep with the book. Use one on Day 4 and one on Day 5, or any time.

Secret heroes week

5 minutes a day for a week, Whole class, Materials: A ‘secret hero’ box, paper hearts

Each child does one quiet kind thing each day (with a grown-up nearby): tidying a shelf, putting a classmate’s coat on its hook. When someone notices a kindness, they drop a heart in the box. At the end of the week, count the hearts together.

Who did this?

10 minutes, Whole class, Materials: A small surprise (a drawing, tidied blocks)

Before children arrive, the teacher does a small kind ‘secret’ act. Children notice it and ask, ‘Who did this?’ Talk about how it felt to find the surprise.

Kindness chain

15 minutes, Whole class, Materials: Paper strips, glue

Each child writes or draws a kind act on a strip. Link the strips into a chain, like the kindness that spread from Bunny to the monkey and the birds.

Science and nature corner

Rabbits live in forests, fields and meadows in many parts of the world. They are often shy and stay close to cover, and many are most active at dawn and dusk. Mother birds sit on their eggs to keep them warm until they hatch. In real life, if you find a bird’s egg or a fallen nest, don’t touch it: tell a grown-up.

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Talk together

Use after reading, at circle time or with a small group. Accept every honest answer.

1. Why do you think Bunny liked to help in secret?

Look for: He wanted to make others' days better, not to be noticed.

2. How do you think the animals felt when they found the problem fixed?

Look for: Happy, surprised, curious. Accept any feeling word.

3. Why did the monkey and the birds start helping too?

Look for: The secret hero inspired them.

4. Is there a small, quiet thing you could do to make someone's day better tomorrow?

Look for: Any answer: tidy up, share, draw a picture.

5. How does it feel inside when you help someone, even if nobody sees?

Look for: Any answer: warm, happy, proud.



Say it together

Who did this?

The big idea: Being kind means helping because it makes someone's day better, even if nobody knows it was you.

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Promise cards

Each child writes or draws one way they can show kindness this week.
Hang them up, then check back on Friday.



I can show kindness by

Name _____



I can show kindness by

Name _____



I can show kindness by

Name _____



I can show kindness by

Name _____

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What to look for

Tick what you notice during the week. Each column names the Ontario frame it shows.

Child	Belonging and Contributing	Self-Regulation and Well-Being	Problem Solving and Innovating	Demonstrating Literacy and Mathematics Behaviours	Notes

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Science and place corner

The book's forest has no name, so we picked Rouge National Urban Park, a big wild park right in Toronto, where people are helping turtles come home.



Eastern cottontail

A cottontail can run about 29 km/h.



American robin

Their eggs are so famous that 'robin's egg blue' became a colour name.



Blanding's turtle

In 2014, as few as six Blanding's turtles were left in the Rouge Valley.



White-tailed deer

A newborn fawn weighs only 1.5 to 2.5 kg.



American red squirrel

In a good year, one squirrel can store enough cones to last two or three years.



Chimpanzee

A chimpanzee is a great ape, not a monkey. It's our closest living relative.

Rouge National Urban Park, Toronto

Bunny: The book calls its hero Bunny and doesn't name the kind of rabbit, so we picked the eastern cottontail, the most common wild rabbit in North America. Real ones are shy too!

Mama Bird: The eggs in the book are white. Real robin eggs are sky blue, and a mother robin is very protective of them.

The turtle: The book doesn't name the turtle, so we picked the Blanding's turtle. Water really matters to it: it lives in wetlands, just like the turtle at the book's watering hole.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/secret-hero

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For every child

English and French learners

Watch the read-aloud first. The sound words (tap-tap, clink-clank, scrape-scrape) and ‘Who did this?’ are easy to join. Use gestures for help, fix and secret.

Children who need more support

Use three stops (spreads 4, 7 and 11). This book is short, with 14 spreads, so it works well for younger children.

Mixed ages and older children

Older children plan a secret kindness for a younger class, like a drawing left in their room, and talk about how it might make them feel.

Handle with care

Saying thank you and being seen are good things too. Bunny’s quietness is his choice, not a rule for everyone.

Real-life safety: children help with a grown-up and in daylight. They shouldn’t fix pipes or go out alone at night.

Never touch a bird’s egg or a fallen nest. Tell a grown-up instead.

Where this value comes from

This story doesn’t come from one culture. Many traditions honour quiet kindness: good done without asking for thanks, that spreads from one person to the next.

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Family letters

Cut apart and send home in the family's language, or copy the text into your newsletter.



English

Today we read Secret Hero, a story about quiet kindness. A shy little bunny helps the forest animals in secret, and soon everyone starts helping each other. At home, try a 'secret kindness' together this week, like leaving a drawing for a neighbour or tidying up for someone, and talk about how it felt. You can watch or read the story together for free at doubleadventure.ca.



Français

Aujourd'hui, nous avons lu une histoire sur la gentillesse discrète : un petit lapin timide aide en secret les animaux de la forêt, et bientôt tout le monde s'entraide. À la maison, essayez ensemble une « gentillesse secrète » cette semaine, comme laisser un dessin à un voisin ou ranger pour quelqu'un, et parlez de ce que vous avez ressenti. Vous pouvez lire ou regarder l'histoire gratuitement sur doubleadventure.ca.



Español

Hoy leímos un cuento sobre la bondad silenciosa: un conejito tímido ayuda en secreto a los animales del bosque, y pronto todos empiezan a ayudarse. En casa, prueben juntos una «bondad secreta» esta semana, como dejar un dibujo a un vecino u ordenar algo para alguien, y hablen de cómo se sintieron. Pueden leer o ver el cuento gratis en doubleadventure.ca.

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Family letters

Continued.



Deutsch

Heute haben wir eine Geschichte über stille Freundlichkeit gelesen: Ein schüchternes kleines Häschen hilft den Waldtieren heimlich, und bald helfen sich alle gegenseitig. Probieren Sie zu Hause diese Woche gemeinsam eine ‚geheime Freundlichkeit' aus, etwa ein Bild für die Nachbarn oder für jemanden aufräumen, und sprechen Sie darüber, wie es sich angefühlt hat. Die Geschichte gibt es kostenlos auf doubleadventure.ca.



Italiano

Oggi abbiamo letto una storia sulla gentilezza silenziosa: un coniglietto timido aiuta in segreto gli animali del bosco, e presto tutti cominciano ad aiutarsi. A casa, provate insieme una «gentilezza segreta» questa settimana, come lasciare un disegno a un vicino o riordinare per qualcuno, e parlate di come vi siete sentiti. Potete leggere o guardare la storia gratis su doubleadventure.ca.

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Exit tickets

Read each line aloud. Children tick what they can do and circle a face.
Four tickets per page.

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

Name _____

Kindness: I can

- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .
- [ ] I can .



How do I feel about it?

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Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Secret Hero

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: kindness.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Being kind means helping because it makes someone's day better, even if nobody knows it was you.

Say it together

Who did this?

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
secret	something only you know	put a finger to your lips
shy	a bit nervous around others	peek through your fingers
fix	to make something work again	pretend to tap with a little hammer
hero	someone who helps others	stand tall with hands on hips
kindness	being gentle and helpful to others	make a heart with your hands

A gentle note

Saying thank you and being seen are good things too. Bunny's quietness is his choice, not a rule for everyone.

Real-life safety: children help with a grown-up and in daylight. They shouldn't fix pipes or go out alone at night.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



Bunny

Eastern cottontail

A small, shy rabbit who helps others in secret



Mama Bird

American robin

Loses an egg in the wind, and gets it back



The turtle

Blanding's turtle

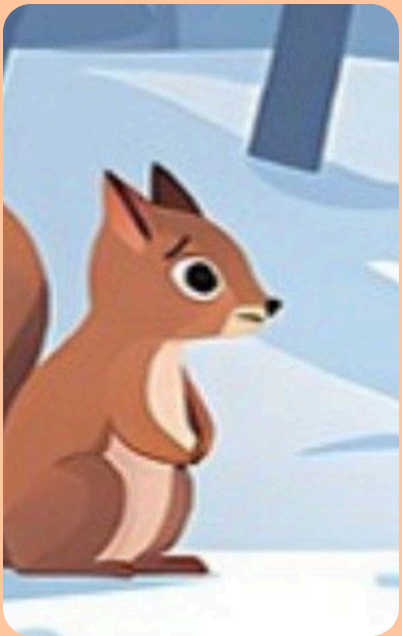
Needs the watering hole



The deer and fawn

White-tailed deer

Can't find food in the snow



The squirrel

American red squirrel

Spots Bunny's secret



The monkey

Chimpanzee

Inspired to help, clears the water paths

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How did they feel?

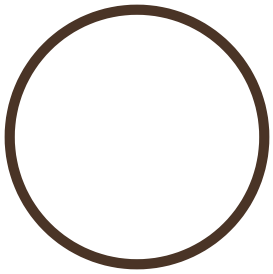
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

The watering hole dries up.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

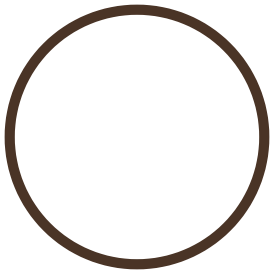


Moment 2

Scrape-scrape! Swish-swish! Bunny clears the snow.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

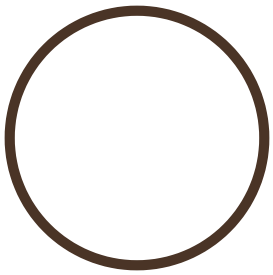


Moment 3

The forest fills with hidden kindness.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

secret something only you know

secret secret

shy a bit nervous around others

shy shy

fix to make something work again

fix fix

Bunny the hero of the story

Bunny Bunny

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Bunny showed kindness. Draw a time when you showed kindness too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Who did this?

You need: A small surprise (a drawing, tidied blocks)

Before children arrive, the teacher does a small kind ‘secret’ act. Children notice it and ask, ‘Who did this?’ Talk about how it felt to find the surprise.

Secret helper

Do one kind thing today without telling anyone. How did it feel to keep it secret?

Zigzag race

Run in a zigzag like a cottontail. Is it harder for someone to catch you?

Robin's egg blue

Find something in your home that's robin's egg blue.

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Secret Hero are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



Bunny

Eastern cottontail

A cottontail can run about 29 km/h.



Mama Bird

American robin

Their eggs are so famous that 'robin's egg blue' became a colour name.



The turtle

Blanding's turtle

In 2014, as few as six Blanding's turtles were left in the Rouge Valley.



The deer and fawn

White-tailed deer

A newborn fawn weighs only 1.5 to 2.5 kg.

Story or real?

The book calls its hero Bunny and doesn't name the kind of rabbit, so we picked the eastern cottontail, the most common wild rabbit in North America. Real ones are shy too!

Where they really live

The book's forest has no name, so we picked Rouge National Urban Park, a big wild park right in Toronto, where people are helping turtles come home.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/secret-hero

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

Who do you think the secret hero is? What could a little bunny do to help?

Secret Hero, talk card 1

Why do you think Bunny liked to help in secret?

Secret Hero, talk card 2

How do you think the animals felt when they found the problem fixed?

Secret Hero, talk card 3

Why did the monkey and the birds start helping too?

Secret Hero, talk card 4

Is there a small, quiet thing you could do to make someone's day better tomorrow?

Secret Hero, talk card 5

How does it feel inside when you help someone, even if nobody sees?

Secret Hero, talk card 6

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Kindness hero

This is to say that

_____

showed kindness, just like Bunny.

Who did this?

_____ _____

Signed Date

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